

okta

The World's Identity Company



Apex powered by Command of the Message[®]



Apex: Why We're Here



Positive Business Outcomes

- \$5B by 2029
- 20% YoY growth
- Increase net new business in Enterprise/Strategic
- Increase deal velocity
- Increase ASP
- Increase win rates



Required Capabilities

- A transformative, career-defining methodology that equips sellers with future-proofed skills
- A consistent sales methodology that unifies GTM teams on elevated sales messaging
- An approach that transforms the way reps and managers work using AI and technology
- Simple, effective and consumable
- Ongoing upleveling skill development



Objectives

01

Attach to our customers' Value Drivers

02

Articulate the value of our product and service offerings

03

Differentiate from the competition

04

Leverage Proof Points that validate our credibility

05

Apply the Framework in a simulated role play

06

Understand how the organization will drive adoption

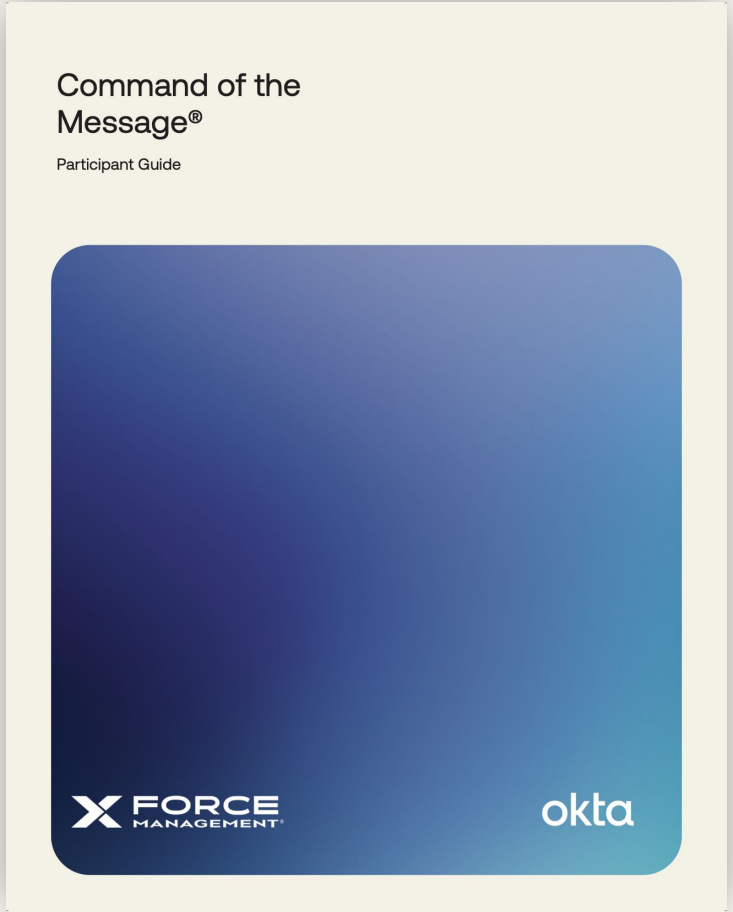


What does it mean to have “COMMAND OF THE MESSAGE®”?

“...Being audible ready to define your solutions to customers’ problems in a way that differentiates you from your competitors and allows you to charge a premium for your products and services.”



Participant Guide



Command of the Message® Training Participant Guide 7

The Value Based Conversation

Establish empathy with current problems
Create urgency around problem implications
Challenge current thinking of what's required to solve the problem
Tie solutions to customer's technical requirement

Before Scenarios **After Scenarios** **Challenge conventional thinking to open their**

Command of the Message® Training Participant Guide 4

Role Play Planner

Use pages 3-4 to complete the training exercises and to prepare for your role play

Your Name: _____
Opportunity Name: _____
Sales Stage: _____

Objectives & Desired Outcome

Their Priority Value Driver	Our Goal for the Call

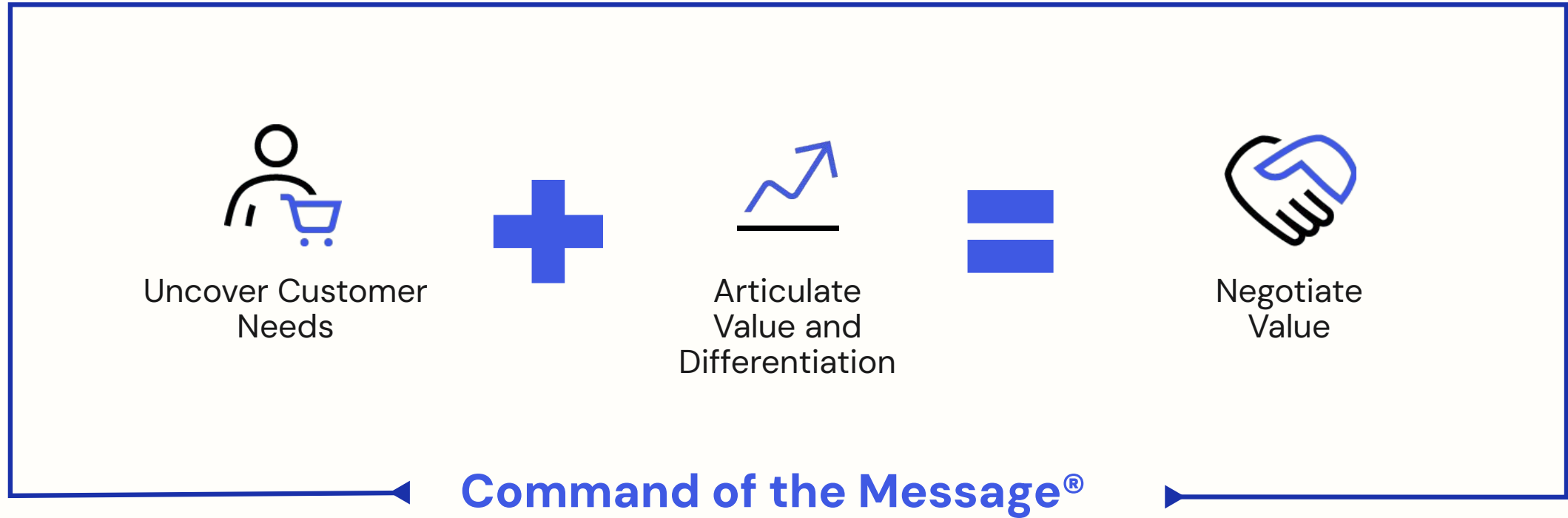
Background (What We've Learned / Heard)

Before Scenarios	Negative Consequences
After Scenarios	Positive Business Outcomes
Required Capabilities	Metrics

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Critical Sales Skills



Essential Questions Exercise



What problems do you currently solve for your customers?



How do you specifically solve these problems?



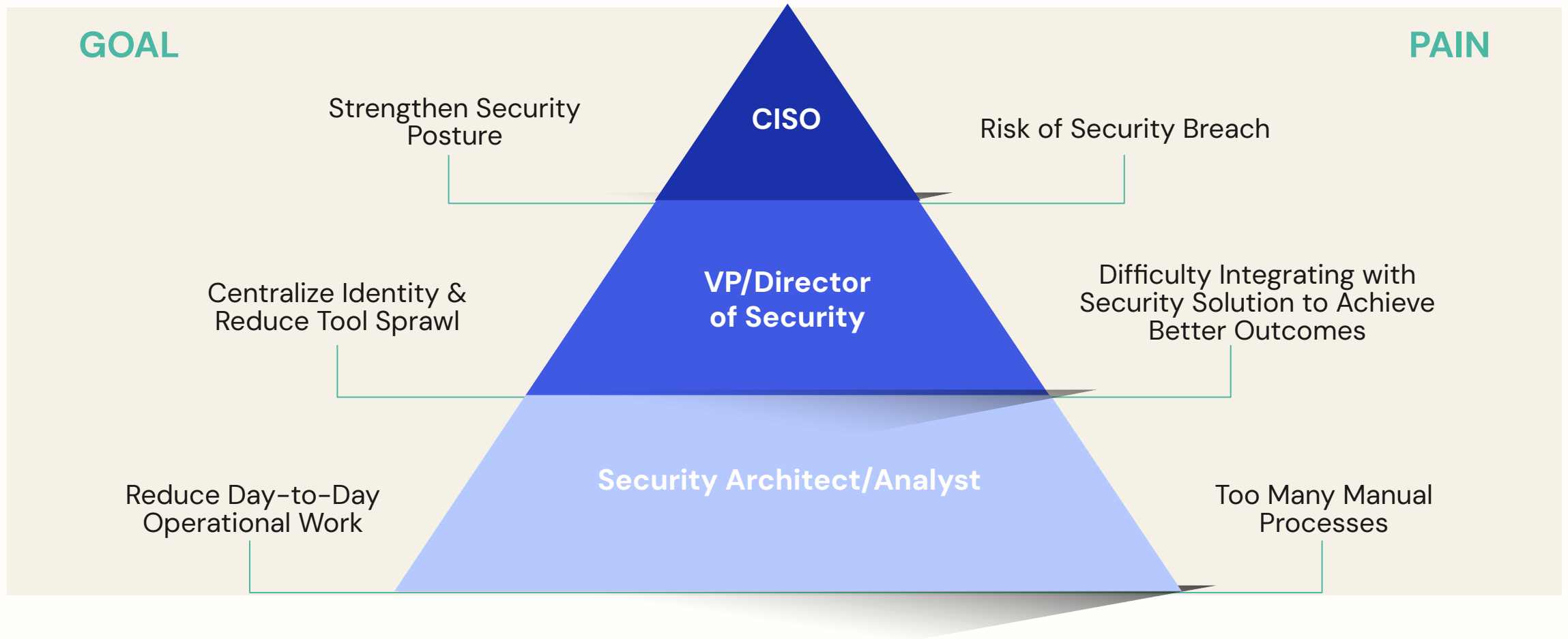
How do you do it differently than your competition?



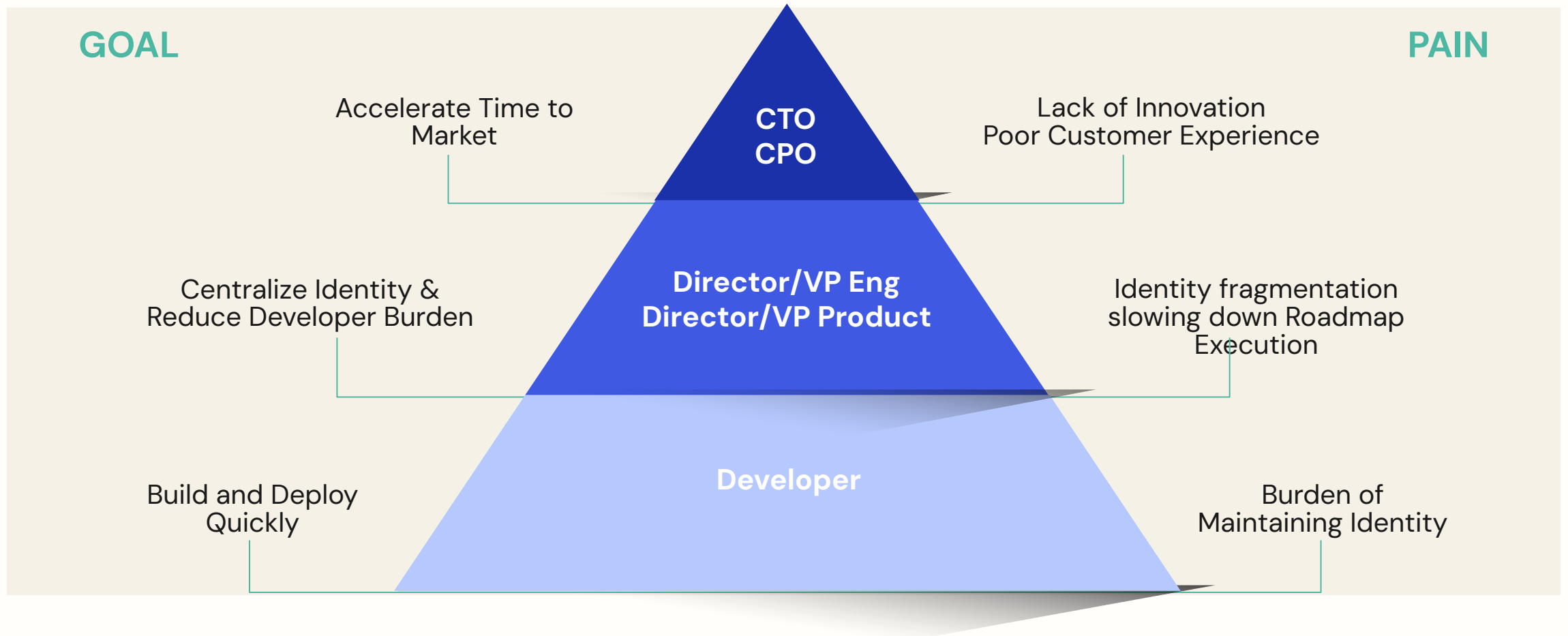
What is your proof?



Attaching to the Biggest Problem – Okta



Attaching to the Biggest Problem – Auth0



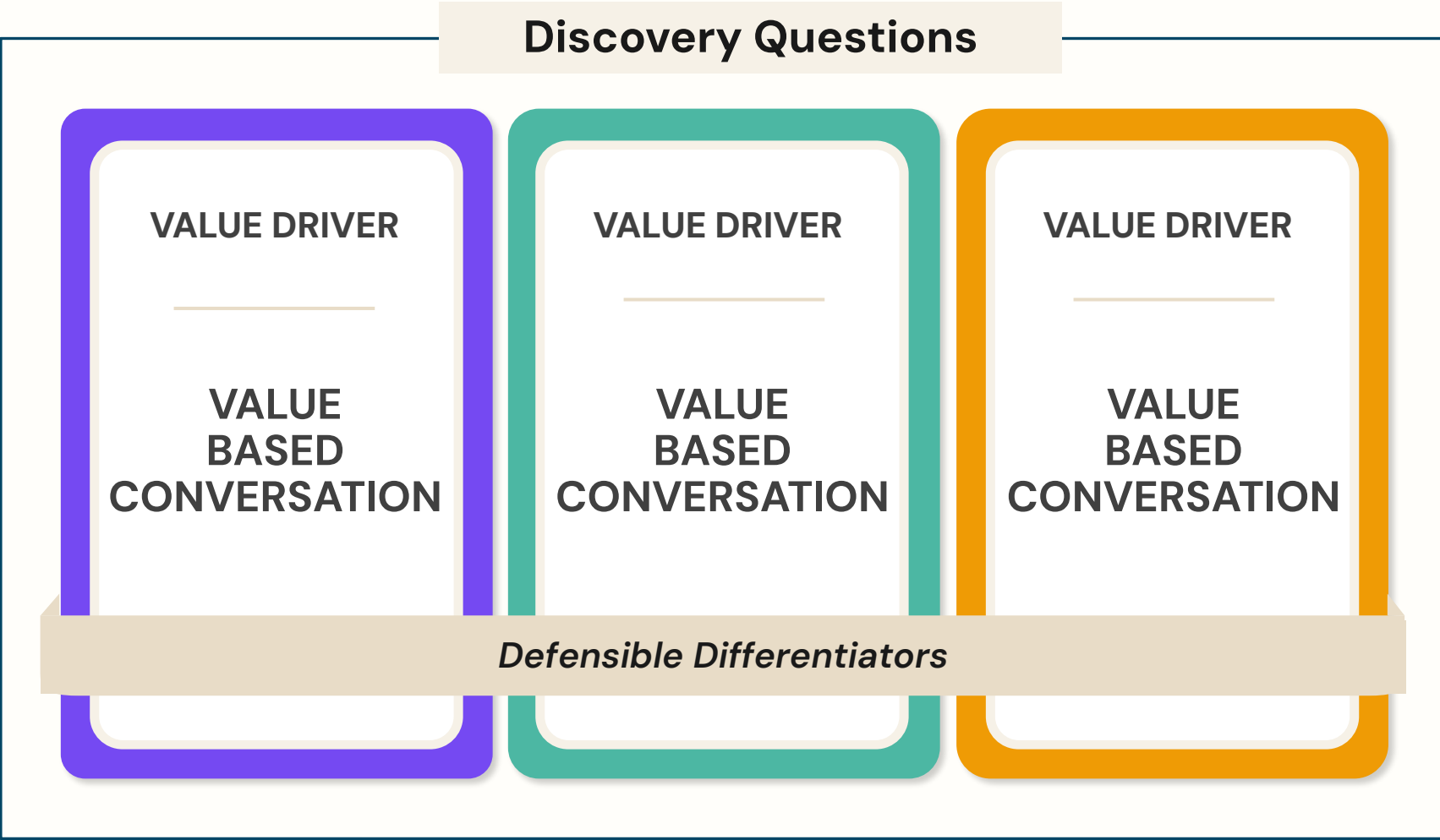
Customer Value Drivers

OKTA VALUE DRIVERS	AUTHO VALUE DRIVERS
<i>CISO, CIO, CTO, CFO, CEO, IT, Ops, Security Teams, Compliance</i>	<i>CTO, CPO, Chief Innovation Officer, CISO, CDO, VP of Engineering</i>
Identity security – breach protection <i>Securing every identity, human or machine, to stop attackers from winning.</i>	Accelerate time to market <i>Accelerate deployment, increase innovation, and reduce the burden of maintaining identity.</i>
Operational efficiency & resilience <i>Scaling the business to accelerate growth in a compliant, resilient, and cost efficient manner.</i>	Elevate the customer experience <i>Deliver a seamless and personalized experience that delights our customers.</i>
AI visibility & control <i>Identify/build, secure, and govern AI agents at scale.</i>	Protect the brand <i>Secure our business and inspire trust with our customers.</i>

Exercise: Which is the Priority Value Driver for your opportunity? Why?
Participant Guide Page 4



The Value Framework



Before Scenarios	After Scenarios
Negative Consequences	Positive Business Outcomes
Required Capabilities	Metrics
How We Do It	Better
Proof Points	

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

Creates a picture of an
 attainable, realistic solution vision
 on which all parties can agree, satisfies
 all parties' needs, and is better
 than the required capabilities
 needed to achieve the Positive
Proof Points that
 the Positive Business Outcomes
 the Value Driver addresses
 and the
How We Know It Better:
 third-party) evidence that
 you can satisfy the
 How your company's
 Required Capabilities and
 product and service
 delivers on the agreed
 offerings satisfy the
 Positive Business Indicators
 The good things will be seen
 Outcomes, calling how well
 perform in the scenarios
 Required Capabilities are
 (improvements) that constitute
 met to achieve the Positive
 Business Outcomes

Metrics and Positive Business Outcomes

Positive Business Outcomes

Metrics

Positive Business Outcomes

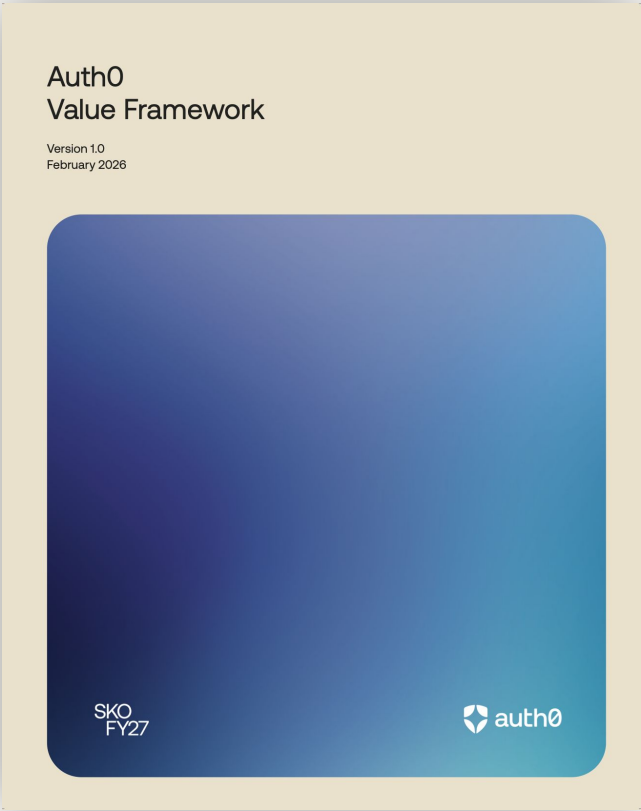
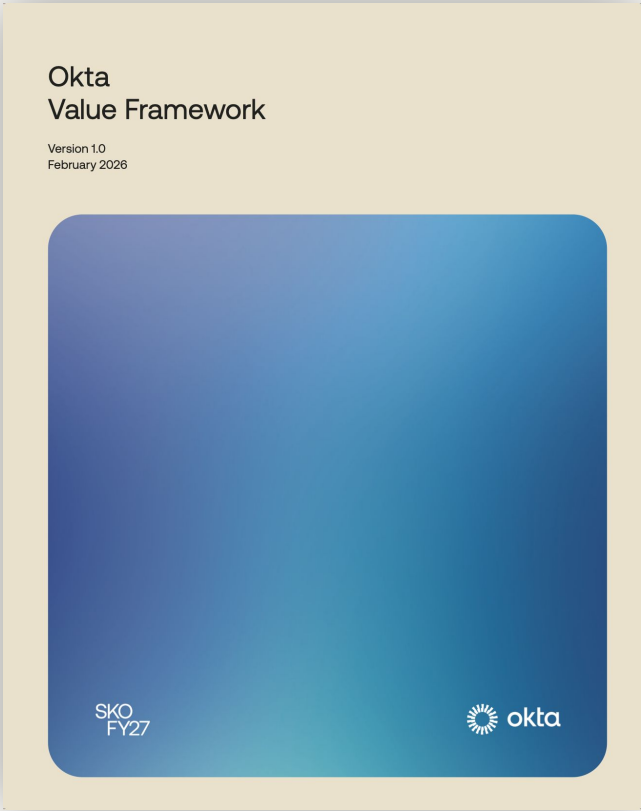
- **Quantifiable business improvements** as a result of the After Scenarios
- **Lagging** indicators of success
- Addresses outcome at the **Economic Buyer** level
- Answers the question: **“Why buy now?”**

Metrics

- Prove delivery of **Required Capabilities** in a quantifiable way
- **Leading** technical indicators
- Address outcomes at a **Technical Buyer** and **Implementation Owner** level
- Answers the questions: **“Why buy from you?”** and **“How do we ensure success?”**



Okta and Auth0 Value Frameworks



For Tomorrow



Bring any questions
from the session today

1



Identify a live
opportunity that you
will begin thinking
through using the
Value Framework

2

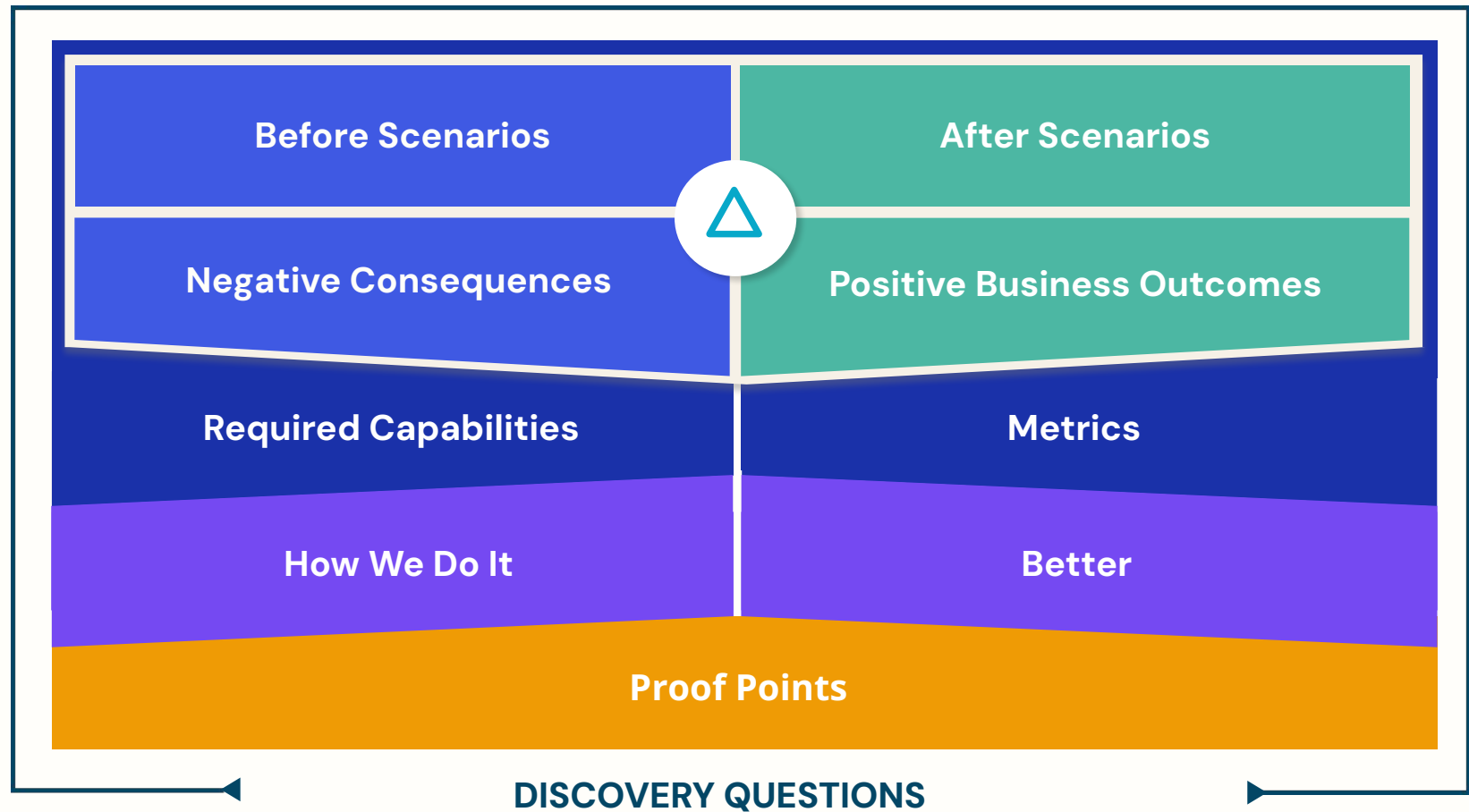


Bring your Value
Framework

3



What's On Your Mind?



Value Based Conversation Exercise – Individual

1. Open your Value Framework to your customer's priority Value Driver
2. Read through the information for that Value Driver, and consider what you already know
3. In the Background (What We've Learned / Heard) section, add content from the Value Framework that you need to get into your next customer conversation(s).

 **FORCE**
MANAGEMENT

Command of the Message®

Training Participant Guide

4

Role Play Planner

Use pages 3-4 to complete the training exercises and to prepare for your role play

Your Name: _____

Opportunity Name: _____

Sales Stage: _____

Objectives & Desired Outcome

Their Priority Value Driver	Our Goal for the Call

Background (What We've Learned / Heard)

Before Scenarios	Negative Consequences
After Scenarios	Positive Business Outcomes
Required Capabilities	Metrics

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Value Based Conversation Exercise – Group

1. Have one person in the group share one Before Scenario / Negative Consequence that could move the needle on their opportunity if they could get the customer to quantify it.
2. As a group, discuss the questions you would ask to get the customer to quantify that Negative Consequence, and begin pulling the conversation to After Scenarios and Positive Business Outcomes.

Be specific about how you would ask questions in a way that both fit your style and resonate with the customer.

 **FORCE**
MANAGEMENT

Command of the Message®

Training Participant Guide

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Required Capabilities	Metrics

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The Mantra – The Ultimate Summation



What I hear you saying is that these are **Challenges** you are trying to address and the **Positive Business Outcomes** you're trying to achieve...

In order to achieve these Positive Business Outcomes, we agreed that these are the **Required Capabilities** you're going to need...

And you'll probably want to measure these Required Capabilities using these **Metrics...**

Let me tell you **How We Do It...**

Let me tell you **How We Do It Better/Differently...**

But don't take my word for it ... **Proof Points**



What We Heard

Challenges

- Compromised accounts/credentials and stolen sessions
- Identity threats accelerated by AI
- Identity is fragmented across multiple systems, broadening attack surface

Outcomes

- Complete visibility into and firm control over the entire identity lifecycle enforcing least privilege access
- Faster time to detect and remediate identity based attacks
- Ensure customers, employees and market confidence in your brand/organization

Required Capabilities & Metrics

- Independent and neutral platform that addresses complex and diverse customer environments
- # of ways the platform can be extended
- # of identity standards supported



Mantra Use Case Exercise

1. In your group, record all the different use cases that you can identify for the Mantra
2. You have **10 minutes** to write down as many use cases for the Mantra as you can. Consider all points of the customer journey, as well as different formats (written, spoken, etc.)
3. Be prepared to share your ideas with the larger group

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The Mantra



What I hear you saying is that these are **Challenges** you are trying to address and the **Positive Business Outcomes** you're trying to achieve.

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Notes

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Mantra Use Case: Early-stage Conversation



When you spoke with **Lead-Gen Colleague** previously, you shared with them that a current business pain is **Priority Value Driver and associated Before/After Scenarios**.

Based on my experience working with similar organization, business with this goal are often responding to **additional hypothesis Challenges or Outcomes**.

Let's spend this time understanding in more depth what this looks like for you, and others, at your organization.



Mantra Use Case: Demo



These are the **Positive Business Outcomes** that we're trying to help you drive.

In order to achieve these Positive Business Outcomes, we agreed that these are the most critical **Required Capabilities** that we're going to focus on today, along with the **Metrics you'll use** to measure any one's ability to deliver these.

Let me show you How We Do It with **DEMO**.

Let me show you How We Do It Better/Differently by **DEMO**.



Mantra Use Case: Customer QBR



What we have agreed to, is that these are the **Positive Business Outcomes** we're helping you achieve.

In order to achieve these Positive Business Outcomes, we have put in place the following **Solutions and Differentiation**.

Here's how we are tracking towards achieving those outcomes **according to the following Metrics** and here's what we need to discuss to take advantage of successes and course correct in order to get back on schedule.



Mantra Use Case: Post-Discovery Email

It was great to catch-up with you and learn more about [<initiative>](#) at [<company>](#).

I wanted to reiterate some key talking points from our conversation to ensure I heard you correctly.

Please let me know if there are any changes or corrections.

Background:

[Customer overview](#)

[Project / Opportunity details](#)

Current Challenges:

[Select Before Scenarios & Negative Consequences](#)

Desired Positive Business Outcomes:

[Targeted Positive Business Outcomes](#)

Regarding **next steps**, I suggest the following:

1. [Confirm Next Call](#)
2. [Share Relevant Proof Point / Video](#)
3. [TBD for your role \(intro team member, schedule QBR, etc.\)](#)

Would love to get your thoughts and feedback.



The Art of Persuasion

“The art of persuasion is a paradox. The more we attempt to persuade people, the more they tend to resist us. But the more we attempt to understand and create value for them, the more they tend to persuade themselves.”

Ron Willingham

Integrity Selling for the 21st Century



Purpose of Discovery Questions



Assist **SELLERS** in ...

- Uncovering customer needs
- Mapping solutions to problems
- Creating a sense of urgency

Assist **CUSTOMERS** in ...

- Clarifying their thoughts
- Articulating their needs
- Evaluating their options



Closed vs Open Ended Discovery Questions

CLOSED-ENDED

Can be answered with one word, usually “yes” or “no”

Create a sense of interrogation

Example:

Do you have tools or processes to identify a compromised account?

OPEN-ENDED

Require a thoughtful response

Encourage a conversation

Example:

Walk me through how you detect and remediate a compromised account in your environment.

T

TELL

E

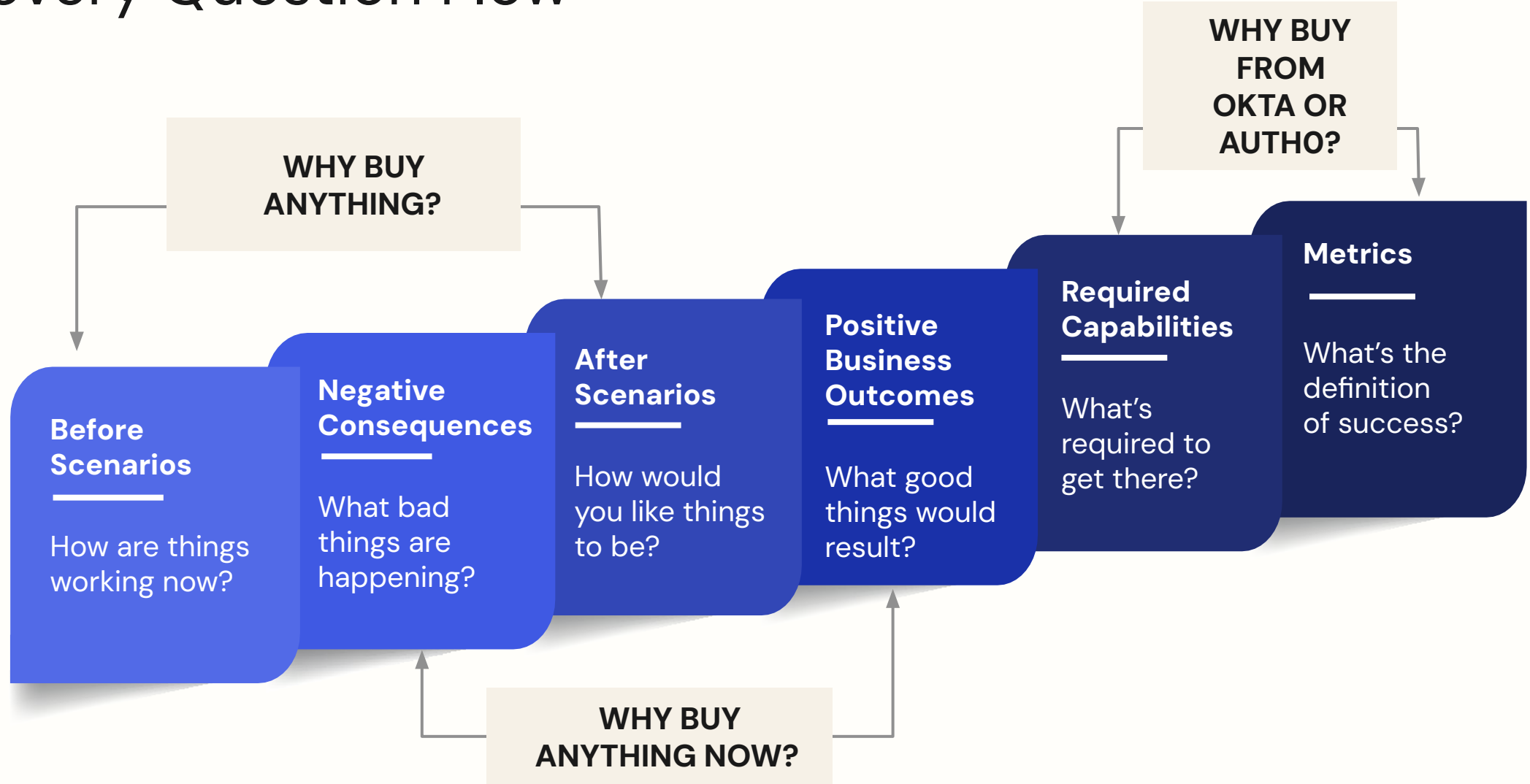
EXPLAIN

D

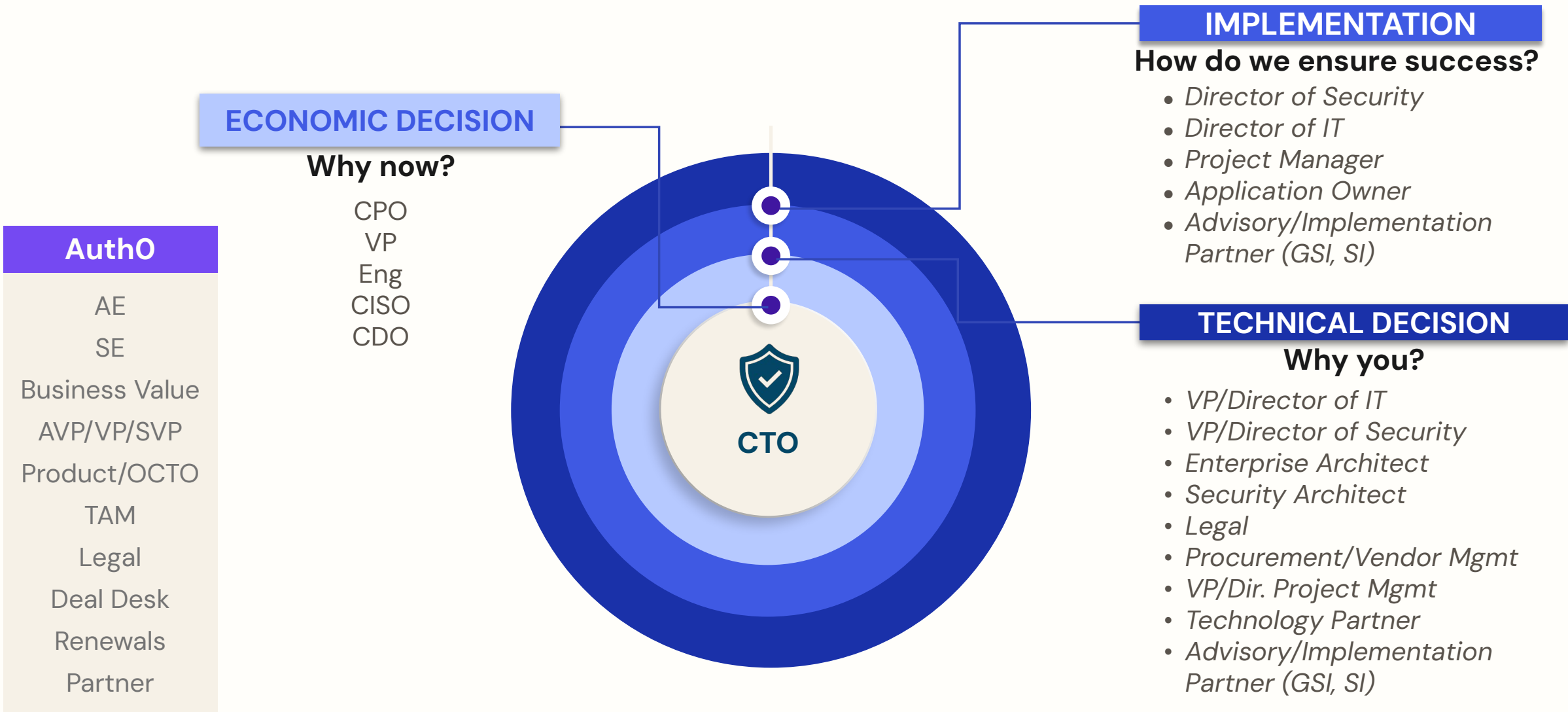
DESCRIBE



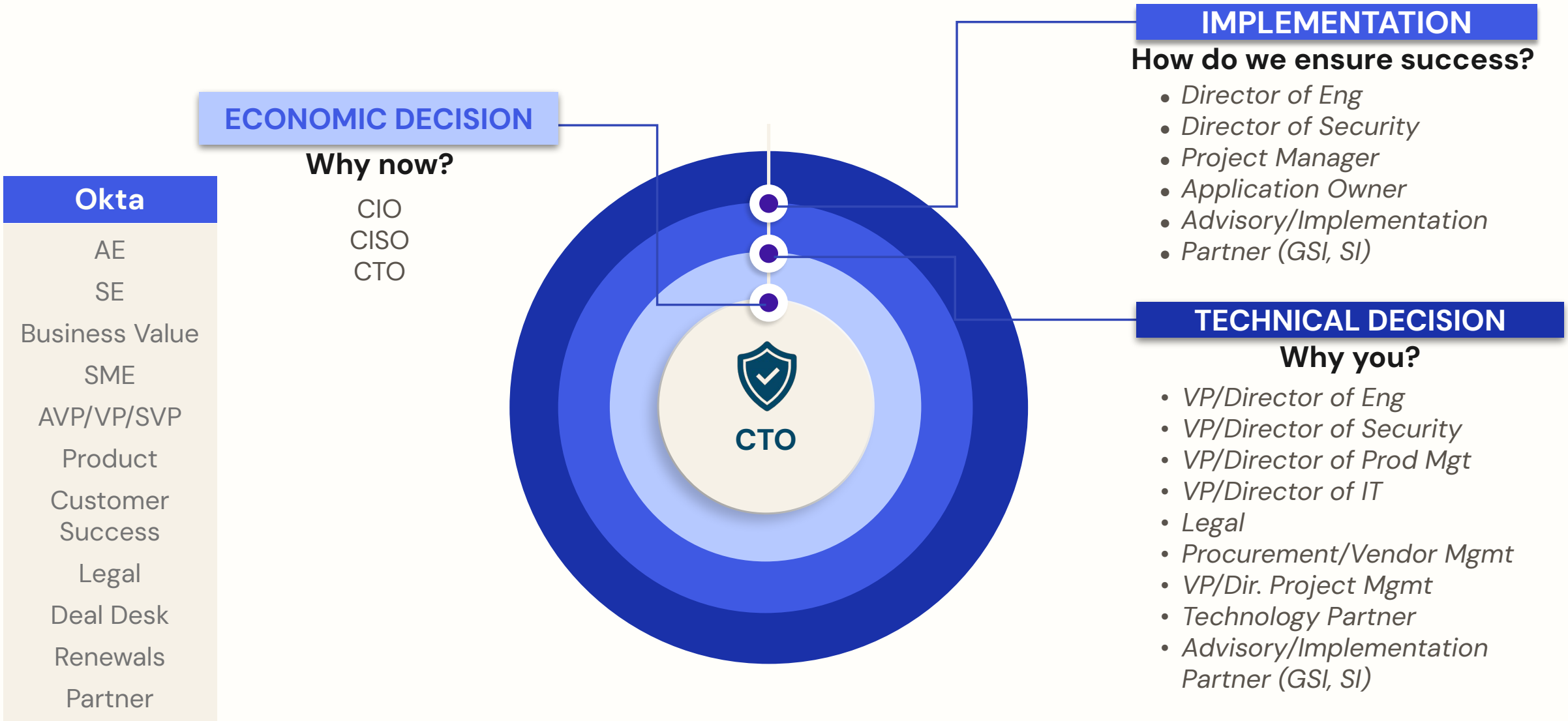
Discovery Question Flow



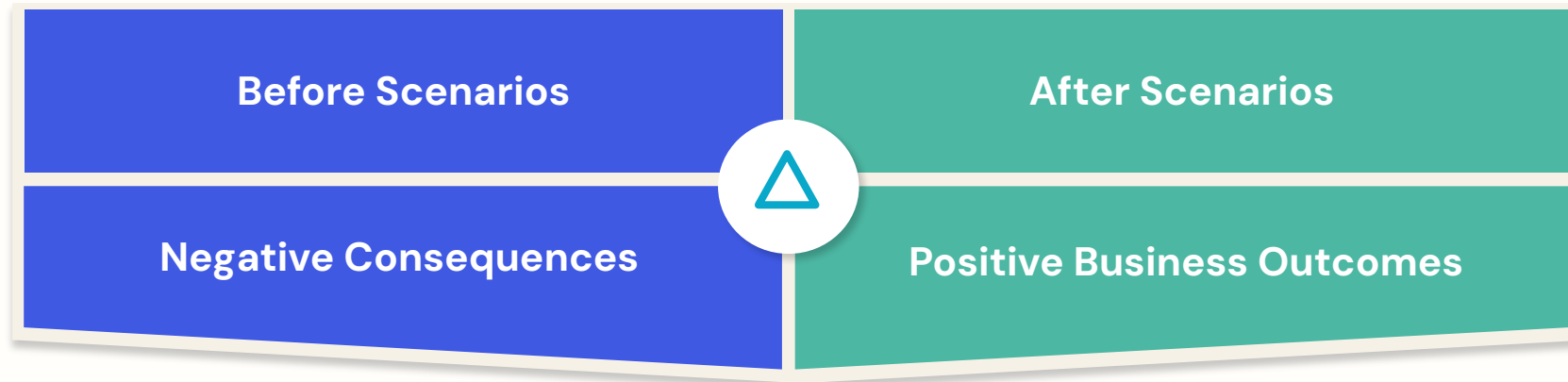
Decision Process: The Collective Yes – Auth0



Decision Process: The Collective Yes – Okta



Expand the Delta with Discovery



Exercise: Open your **Value Framework** to the Discovery Questions section of your Value Driver. Choose 3–5 Discovery Questions that you can use to **Expand the Delta** in your opportunity. Write them down on **Participant Guide Page 5**.

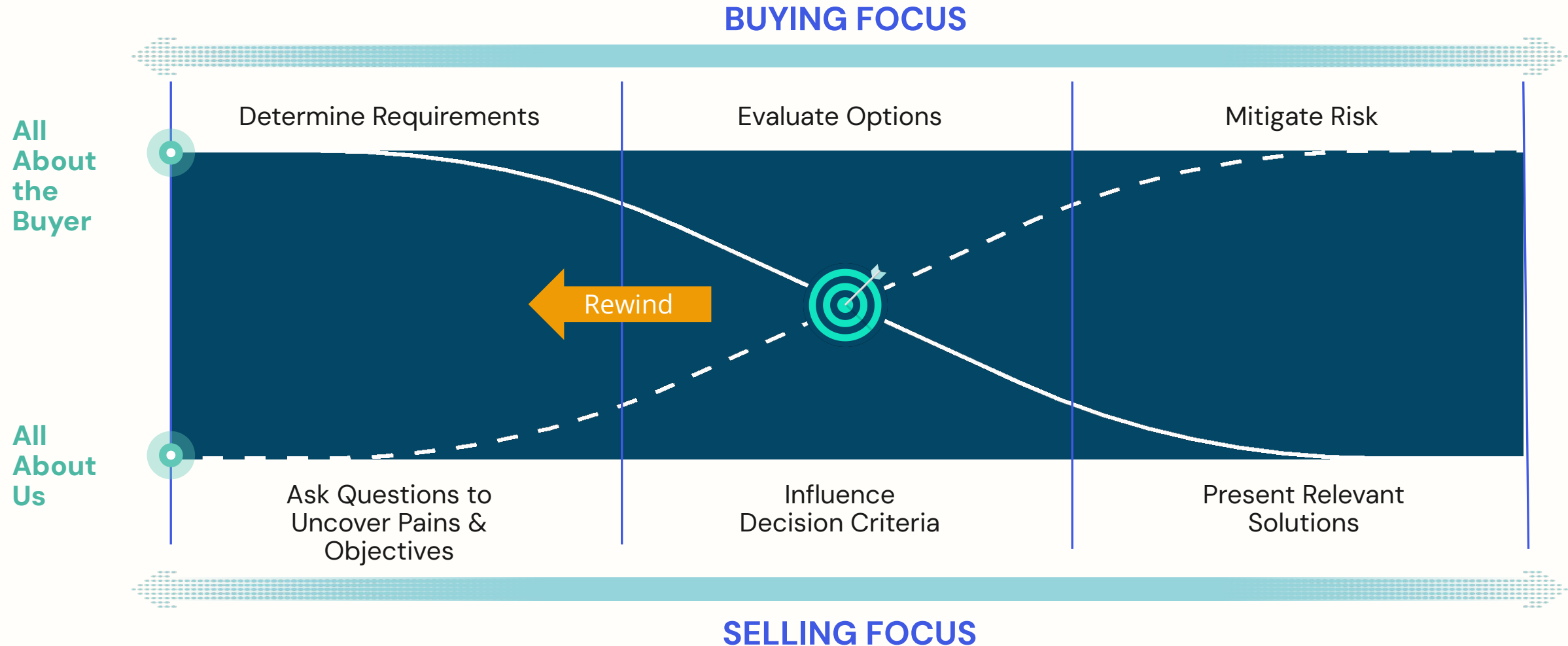


Discovery Exercise

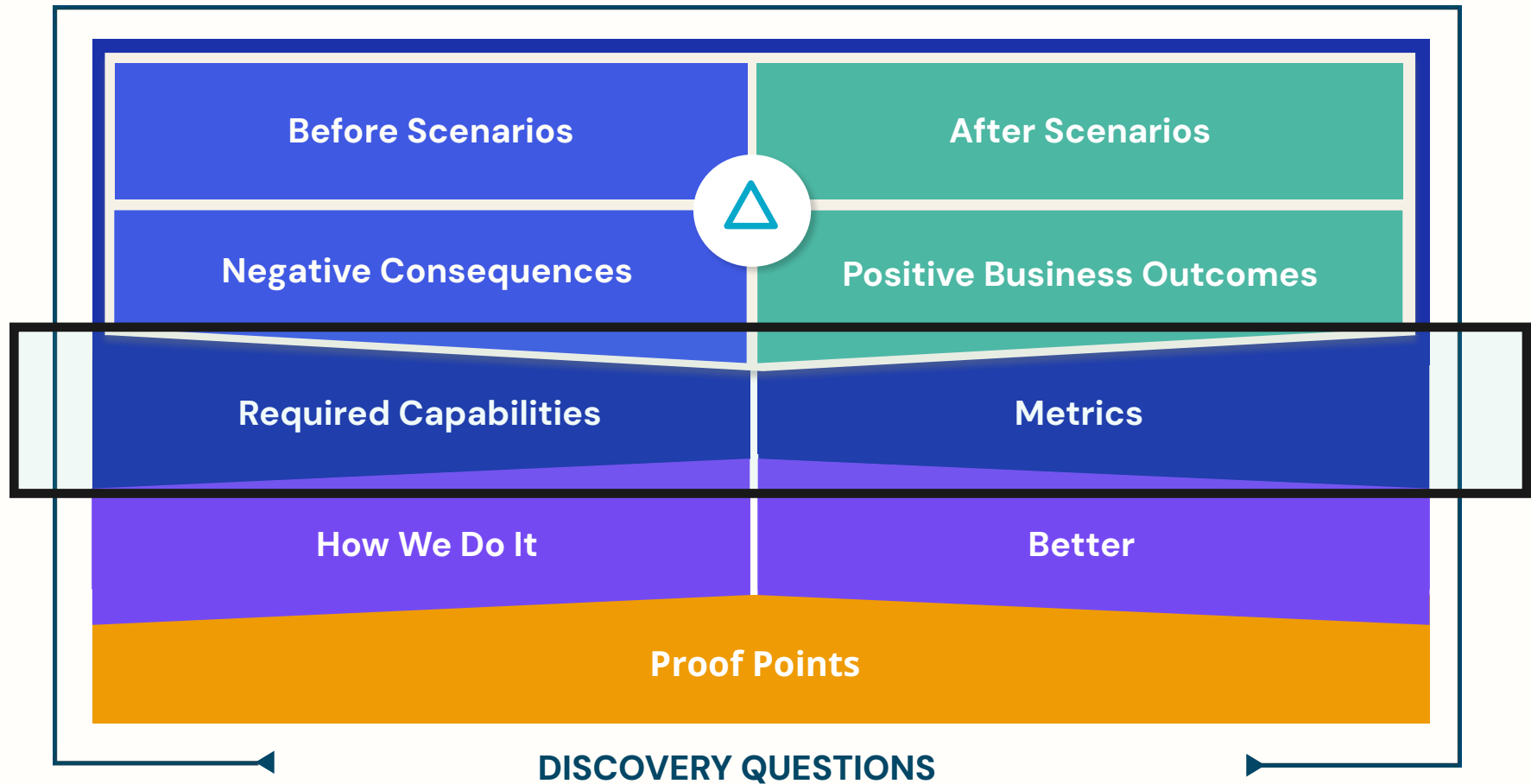
1. In your group, select one opportunity to use for Discovery practice
2. The opportunity owner will share the Priority Value Driver and their objective for the next conversation (e.g., better understand business pain and positive business outcomes)
3. The opportunity owner will act as the customer and the rest of the group will act as the “seller,” and ask questions to create a great Discovery conversation



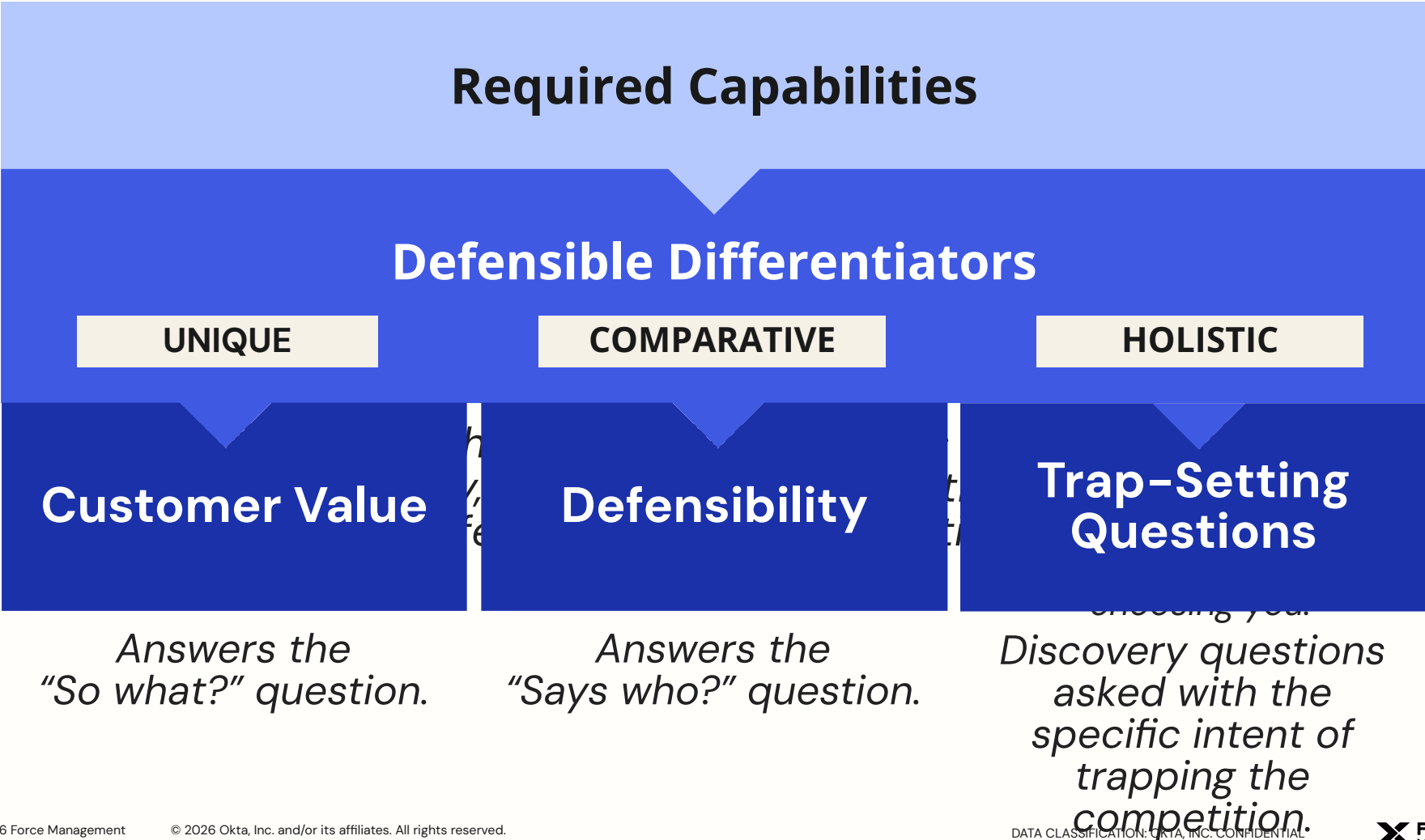
Changing the Conversation



Required Capabilities & Metrics



The Differentiator Types and Components



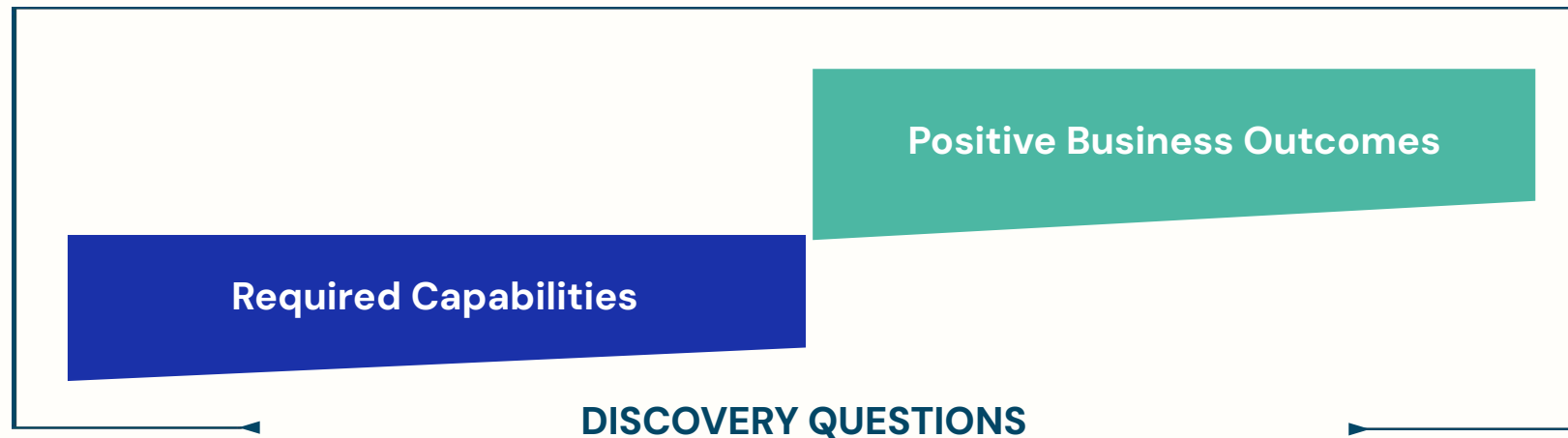
Defensible Differentiators

OKTA DIFFERENTIATORS	AUTHO DIFFERENTIATORS
Secure your AI agents' identities	Leading developer experience
Leading identity security end to end platform	Extensibility, customization, & orchestration
Integrations & tech partnerships	Secure production- ready AI agents
Independent, vendor-neutral & trusted partner	One identity platform for every business model
Ease of deployment, maintenance, & scale	Trust: Availability, Scalability, Security, & Compliance



Required Capabilities & Trap-Setting

Required Capabilities are the minimum solution capabilities that are required to achieve the **Positive Business Outcomes** and After Scenarios



Trap-Setting means asking Discovery Questions with the intent of influencing the customer's **Required Capabilities** with your differentiation and put the competition on the defensive



Influencing Required Capabilities

TRAP = Breadth and Depth of Integrations (Okta Integrations & Tech Partnerships DD)

Set Topic

(with a Before or After Scenario)

Tell me how you onboard new applications into your identity infrastructure.

Open Trap

(to uncover Negative Consequences or Positive Business Outcomes)

Walk me through how your team securely/timely implements new applications.

- Tell me what you/your team does when those apps don't smoothly integrate into your existing IDP?
- Walk me through how these additional work efforts impact your ability to deliver for your customers (employees).
- Describe security risks introduced into your environment when you develop custom integrations.

Close Trap

(for Required Capabilities and Metrics)

Tell me how onboarding new applications would change if you no longer had to build custom integrations.



Influencing Required Capabilities Exercise

- Open your Value Framework to the Differentiators section
- On Page 5 of your Participant Guide, identify the Differentiator that gives us the greatest advantage against the competition?
- Review the Trap Setting Question thread for that Differentiator and adjust the thread of questions to use in your next conversation
- Discuss your Trap Setting Question thread with your table for their feedback

FORCE MANAGEMENT Command of the Message® Training Participant Guide 5

Discovery Questions

To Uncover Challenges <i>(Before Scenarios & Negative Consequences)</i>	To Uncover Outcomes <i>(After Scenarios & Positive Business Outcomes)</i>

Competition

Primary Competition _____ Relevant Differentiator(s) _____

Trap-Setting Thread

- Set Topic
- Open Trap
- Close Trap

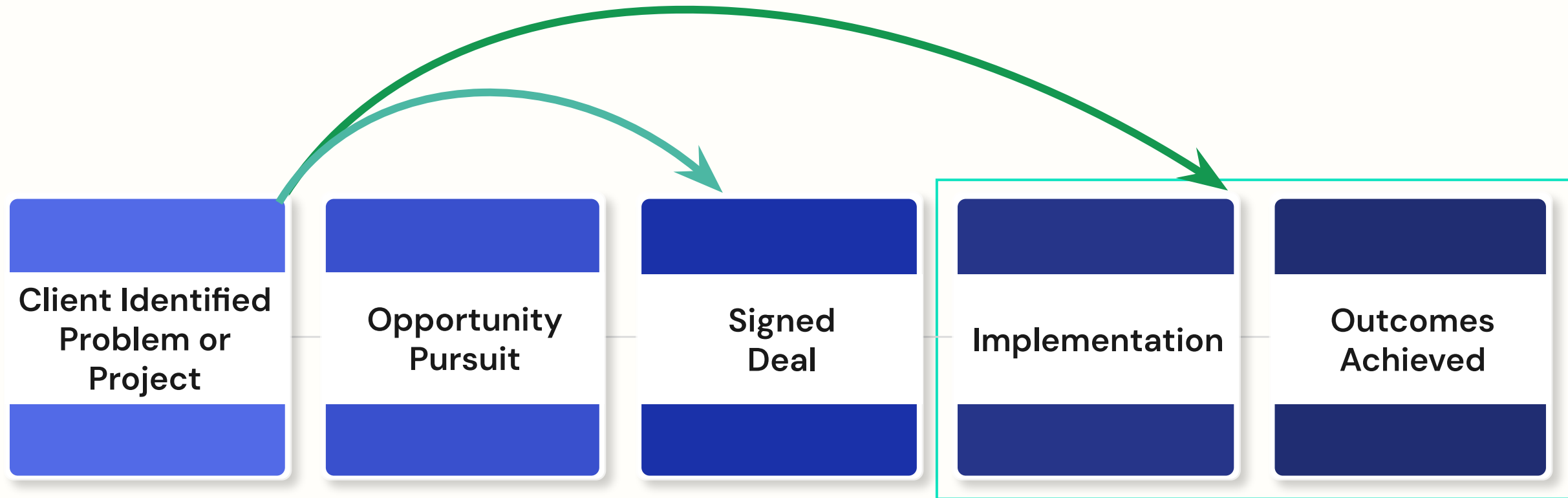
Call Notes

Before Scenarios & Negative Consequences	After Scenarios & Positive Business Outcomes
Required Capabilities & Metrics	How We Do It, Better & Proof Points

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Expanding the Conversation

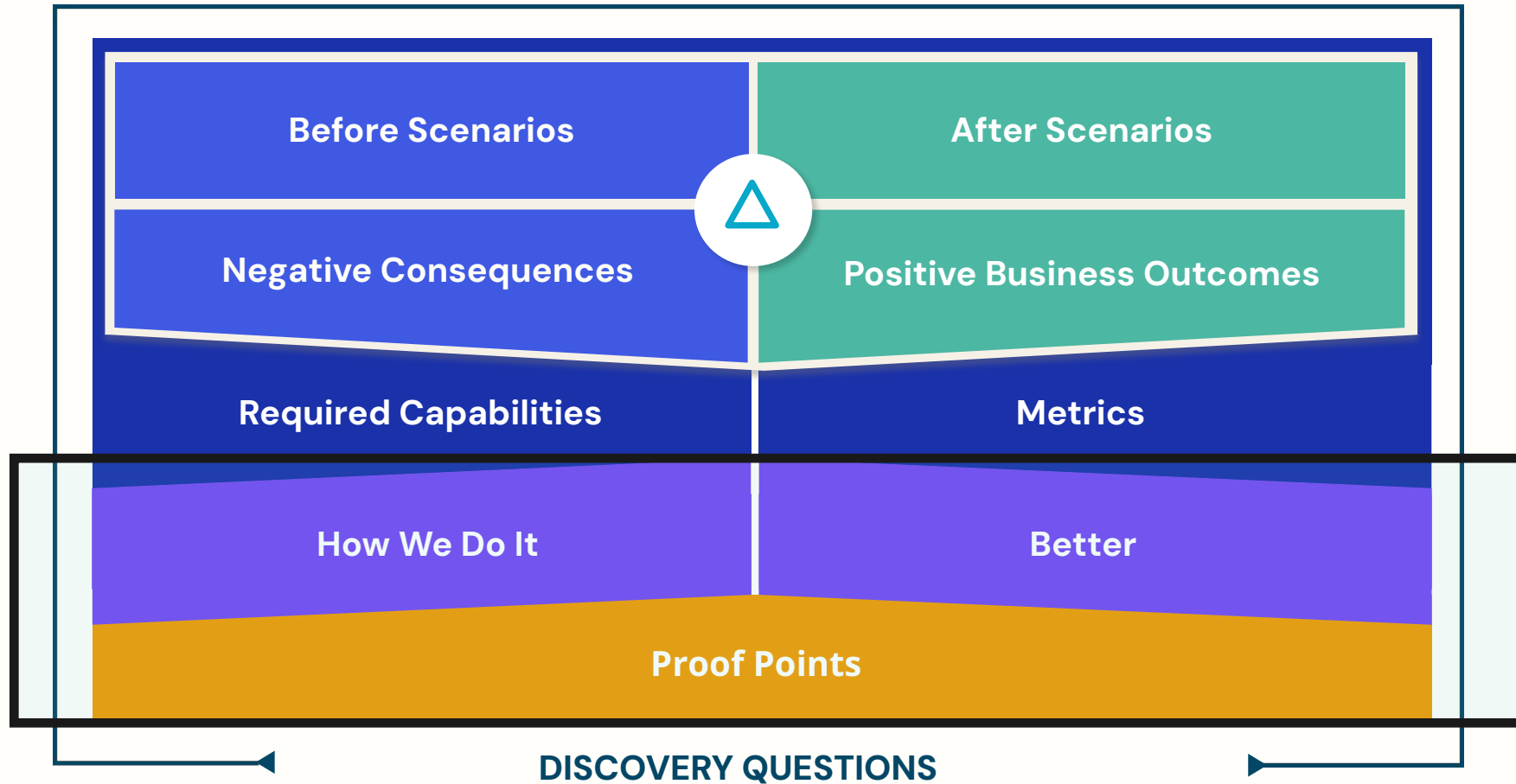


What happens when we focus on successful outcomes?

- We engage with other critical decision makers and more easily identify potential Champions
- We expand the potential business outcomes and influence critical Required Capabilities and Metrics
- We have more opportunities to set traps for additional differentiators



How We Do It & Better



Turning the Corner with The Ultimate Summation



What I hear you saying is that these are **Challenges** you are trying to address and the **Positive Business Outcomes** you're trying to achieve.

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And you'll probably want to measure these Required Capabilities using these **Metrics**.

Let me tell you **How We Do It**.

Let me tell you **How We Do It Better/Differently**.

But don't take my word for it ... **Proof Points**

HOW ARE
THINGS
WORKING
NOW?

HOW
WOULD
YOU LIKE
THEM TO
BE?

WHAT'S
REQUIRED
TO GET
THERE?



The Art of Delivering How We Do It & Better

How We Do It	We meet <i>Required Capability</i> with <i>How We Do It</i>
How We Do It Better	We're better at hitting <i>Metric</i> with <i>How We Do It Better</i>
Proof	That gives you the best chance of achieving <i>Positive Business Outcome</i> , just like "customer" did in <i>Proof Point</i>



Role Play Overview

PURPOSE

- Practice using CoM language and Okta content to drive higher value conversations
- Learn from others
- Get CoM into the DNA of Okta

HOW

- Using your SKO opportunity you will prepare for a 20-minute role play
- Prepare your conversation and a one-page overview for your partner who will sit in the customer's chair
- You will serve as seller once, customer once and observer twice to give others feedback

WHEN

- Post SKO virtual session
- Dates assigned by enablement team

SUCCESS

- Take the time to prepare for your conversation as you would for a live customer
- Prepare your partner prep sheet so that your partner can easily represent the customer for you
- Block the time assigned for your session and show up prepared to learn and coach



Role Play Preparation



Prepare your Partner

- Use the **Partner Prep Sheet** that will be provided
- Prepare your Partner to play your prospect/customer

The Partner Prep Sheet is a form titled 'Prewrite: Role Play Partner Prep Sheet'. It includes fields for 'Opportunity & Contact Name', 'Prospect / Customer Background', 'Competitive Alternatives & / or Anticipated Objections', 'Priority Value Driver & Associated Before Scenario / Negative Consequences', 'After Scenario & PPOs', and 'Required Capabilities & Metrics'. It also has a section for 'What problems have these people experienced?' and 'What problems are technical in nature?'. The form is labeled 'Confidential | ©2023-2026 Force Management'.



Prepare Yourself

- Review your completed **Role Play Planner** on p. 4-5 in the PG
- Make any necessary additional updates

The Role Play Planner is a form titled 'Role Play Planner'. It includes fields for 'Your Name', 'Opportunity Name', 'Sales Stage', 'Objectives & Desired Outcomes', 'Our Goal for the Call', 'Background (What We've Learned / Heard)', 'Before Scenario', 'Negative Consequences', 'After Scenario', 'Positive Business Outcomes', 'Required Capabilities', and 'Metrics'. It is labeled 'Confidential | ©2023-2026 Force Management'.



Role Play Timing

Each Group of 4



Pair 1

- **Partner 1:** 10 Minute Partner Prep | 20 Min Role Play | 10 Min Group Debrief
- **Partner 2:** 10 Minute Partner Prep | 20 Min Role Play | 10 Min Group Debrief

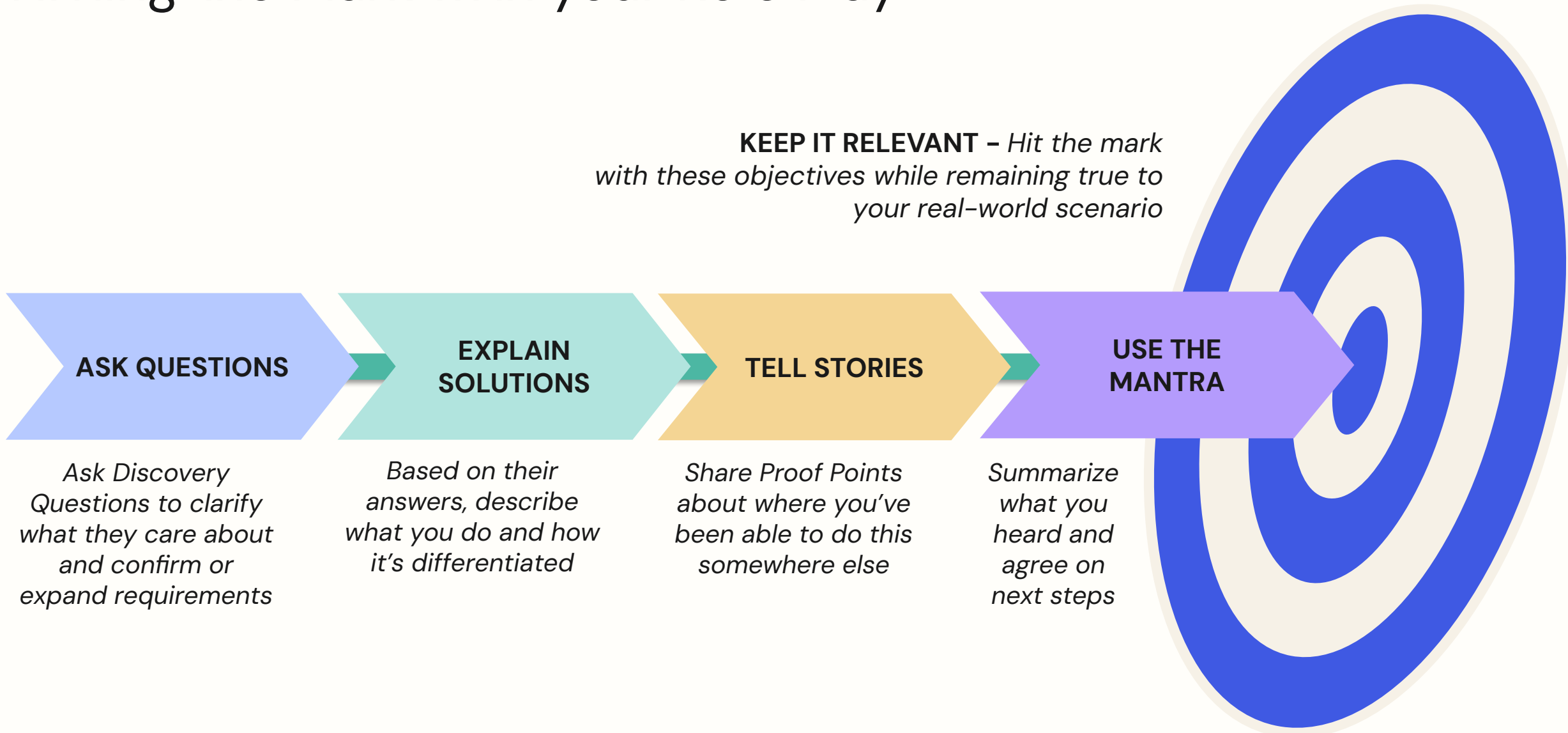


Pair 2

- **Partner 1:** 10 Minute Partner Prep | 20 Min Role Play | 10 Min Group Debrief
- **Partner 2:** 10 Minute Partner Prep | 20 Min Role Play | 10 Min Group Debrief



Hitting the Mark with your Role Play



Mastering the Motion

Your 6-Month Success Roadmap

Continuous Learning

1. **Field-Ready Practice:** Role plays to practice methodology execution in a safe space.
2. **Localized Reinforcement:** Targeted sessions tailored to your segment or role, delivered through your existing enablement cadences
3. **Peer-Led Excellence:** Direct support from APEX Champions to bridge the gap between theory and winning in the field.
4. **New Hire Readiness:** Onboarding Assembly and Presales University will include critical CoM content to ensure success from Day 1.

Operational Integration

1. **Embedded Workflow:** CoM & MEDDPICCC integrated directly into Salesforce & Gong to guide your daily workflow.
2. **AI-Powered Prep:** Automate call prep with CoM to allow you to uncover pain, articulate value, and define Required Capabilities with speed and scale.
3. **Deal Execution Rigor:** WinLabs and 1:1 deal coaching anchored in CoM to drive unified deal strategy and cross-functional alignment

On-Demand Resources

1. **Methodology HQ:** Your central hub in Highspot for Value Frameworks, First Call tools, and CoM GEM guides.
2. **Formula to Win:** Role-specific playbooks (ASD + AE) defining the clear path to "Great" at every stage.
3. **Real-Time Guardrails:** WalkMe integration and Salesforce Tool Tips providing "just-in-time" prompts within your core sales tools.



Thank you!

